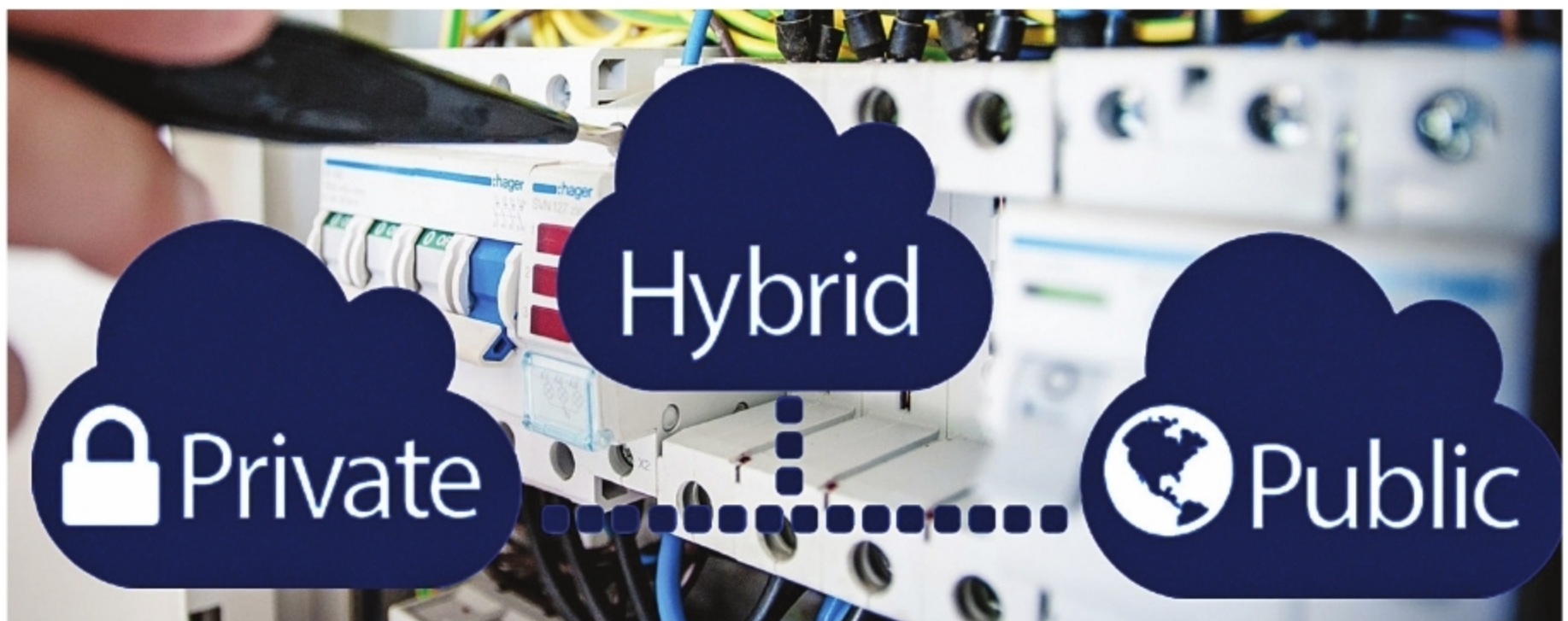


Hybrid Cloud: New Edge *for* Cloud Providers

As the networking business moves from OEMs to software vendors, many networking functions are now being developed on software and deployed on commodity servers. This has given a boost to virtual network functions, which provide networking nodes functionalities such as routers and firewalls through software.



Edge computing is taking up a pivotal role in telecom industries. Next-generation networks require computing power close to end devices, at the front of the networks. In fact, such requirements have been attributed to real-time or low latency, which needs processing of data at the point, or near the point, where it is being generated and produced.

Edge computing can be addressed through dedicated or privately-held virtualised infrastructure. It brings the cloud for edge-specific requirements. There are vendors like VxWorks and RedHat who provide virtualised infrastructure for edge computing needs—they also certify software for cloudification or virtualisation.

There has been strong interest in cloud providers capturing the edge, and they have been active in this space by offering hybrid cloud, which is a mix or distributed form of cloud computing with the right harmonisation and orchestration. There have also been several mergers and acquisitions in this direction, including IBM and VxWorks.

An edge for cloud providers, edge cloud

Edge is the hierarchical distribution of certain functionalities in exchange-to-exchange (E2E) construct with the intent of being at the front or close to edge. Edge disrupts the very nature of cloud services, as it creates a moat for innovation and business.

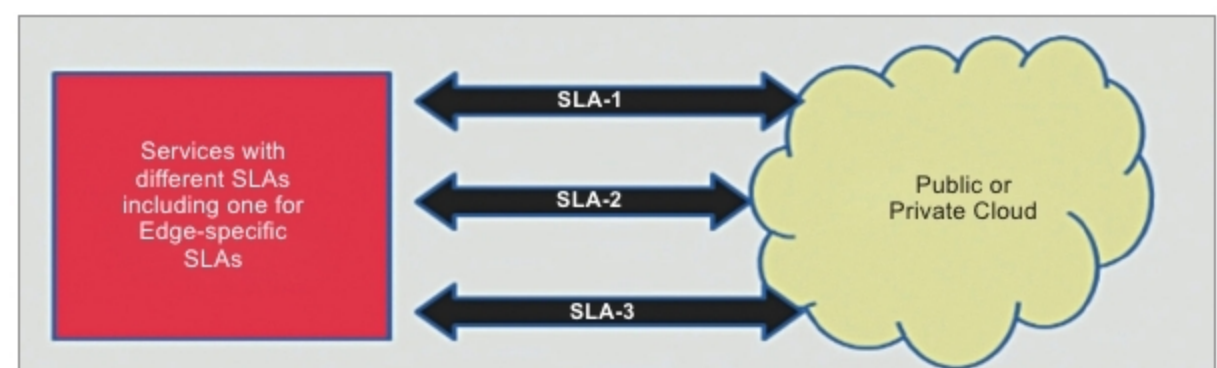


Figure1: Hybrid cloud